SAAN ISAAC GEORGE

Chief of Staff | Founder's Office | Strategy, Operations & AI
Bengaluru, India · +91 99866 36752 · saanisaac10@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/saan-isaac-926ba0ab

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Operator with 8+ years across EdTech, QSR, EV, consulting and retail, working alongside CEOs, CXOs and Senior Partners to turn ambiguous problems into decisions, and decisions into systems that hold. Builds with AI hands-on, brings a commercial lens to people and operations, makes the call and owns the result end to end.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **$200-300K added revenue per quarter:** redesigned Sales incentives around Contribution Margin; productivity rose 10-15% and incentive costs fell by ~$100K.
- **CEO-ready hiring diagnosis in 8 weeks:** used AI on 12,600+ applications across 25 roles to show conversion, not demand, was the constraint, and where to act by role and channel.
- **3 months, ~470 people, 2 AI tools:** at California Burrito, hired ~70 corporate roles, onboarded ~400 store staff and shipped an AI-enabled ATS and onboarding app.
- **Built AI tools, not just processes:** screening cut from 2-3 hours to 20 minutes per role per day; onboarding 4x faster for ~200 joiners a month.
- **HR response time cut 65%** via an in-house AI coaching platform; employees rating their performance conversations effective rose from 20% to 30% company-wide.
- **30% of Director+ leaders moved up** after a 2-cohort programme for ~20 leaders; Sales engagement rose from 3.0 to 4.6 (out of 5) over 3 years.

CORE SKILLS

CEO & CXO Partnership · Strategic Problem Solving · Business Operations · Cross-functional Programme Leadership · Organisation Design · Incentive & Commercial Design · Workforce & Headcount Planning · M&A Integration · Data Analysis & Executive Storytelling · Building Tools with AI (Claude)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of HR

California Burrito · QSR chain, 150+ stores, ~3,000 employees · Jul 2026 – Sep 2026

- Owned the people function for a fast-scaling QSR business: hiring, labour compliance, engagement and reporting across 150+ stores.
- Gave the CEO an AI-led diagnosis: screening and conversion, not candidate supply, was the bottleneck; flagged sourcing gaps by role and roles where pay bands, not channels, were the issue.
- Hired ~70 corporate roles in 2 months across IT, AI Engineering, Supply Chain, Finance, Marketing and Store Operations.
- Built a custom ATS with Claude: source tracking, outcome-based shortlisting, an audit trail per hire and AI pre-assessment of reasoning and aptitude.
- Shipped a frontline onboarding app that auto-reads Aadhaar and bank details from ID cards and cheques, synced to Keka.
- Launched Management Trainee and internship programmes and set up statutory compliance accountability across sites.

Associate Director, Talent Management & HR Business Partner

Emeritus (EdTech, 3,000+ employees) · Bengaluru, covering India, US and APAC · 2021 – Jul 2026 · Reported to Head of Talent Management / CHRO · Team of 4

- Strategic partner to business heads for ~1,000 employees across Sales, Revenue, Tech and Delivery.
- Replaced a tenure-based Sales incentive plan with one tied to Contribution Margin and input metrics, with predictable payouts.
- Drove Revenue team productivity studies that set headcount allocation and hiring budgets across India, US and APAC.
- Led people integration for cross-border acquisitions, aligning policies and operating rhythms across regions.
- Built a Sales career framework that created a pipeline of team leads, opened interim-manager roles and fixed a base-heavy structure.

- Designed and ran the Director+ leadership programme across 2 cohorts, and rolled out OKR-based performance management across business units.
- Built an AI coaching and feedback platform for managers and senior leaders, integrated with the HRMS.
- Hired 20-30 roles a month, cut Sales Advisor time-to-hire to 2 weeks and met the 5% PwD hiring target.

Talent Consultant
PwC Acceleration Center · Bengaluru, covering India, Shanghai and Colombia · Jul 2020 – Dec 2021

- Led the Talent Consulting team through a leadership transition, aligning priorities directly with Senior Partners.
- Built the Power BI talent dashboard Partners used in quarterly reviews.
- Benchmarked Tech Consulting pay with Korn Ferry, leading to recalibrated offer bands.

Talent Partner
Ather Energy (EV technology, Series C+) · Bengaluru · Apr 2018 – Jul 2020

- Built performance management from scratch for ~400 employees with the CTO and CHRO.
- Worked with CXOs on restructuring and efficiency initiatives during rapid scale-up.
- Hired a batch of 20 Graduate Engineer Trainees across 10 IITs.

Senior Merchandise Specialist
Target Corporation (Fortune 50 retail) · Bengaluru · May 2012 – Jun 2015

- Automated 3 merchandising and forecasting processes in VBA, saving 2,820 hours a year.

EDUCATION

- PGDM, Human Resource Management & Strategy, T.A. Pai Management Institute (TAPMI), Manipal, 2018
- BBM, Human Resources, Christ University, Bengaluru, 2012

EXECUTIVE EDUCATION

Columbia Business School: Corporate Governance (2025) · Wharton: High-Impact Teams (2024), Talent Management (2023) · Cambridge: People Analytics (2022)